

Overlay Guides

by FlorindoLAB

Composition guides on top of
any software.

User guide

Version 1.0.0

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Overview

Overlay Guides displays composition guides (rule of thirds, golden ratio, diagonals, center cross, golden triangle) in a **transparent window** placed over your working area: Blender, an editing application, a video player… Frame your shot, compare it, check your camera axes, without changing anything in your software.

WHAT IT DOES

5 combinable guides

Rule of thirds, golden ratio, diagonals, center cross and golden triangle, each with its own color.

3 draggable markers

Numbered circles you can place anywhere, to compare your camera axes.

Multiple overlays

One tab per overlay, each with its own identification color and its own on/off switch.

Click-through mode

Ctrl+Alt+G: clicks pass through the overlay to the software underneath.

Window layer

Overlay another window (an exported shot, for instance) with adjustable opacity.

Settings remembered

Guides, colors, window position and size are kept from one session to the next.

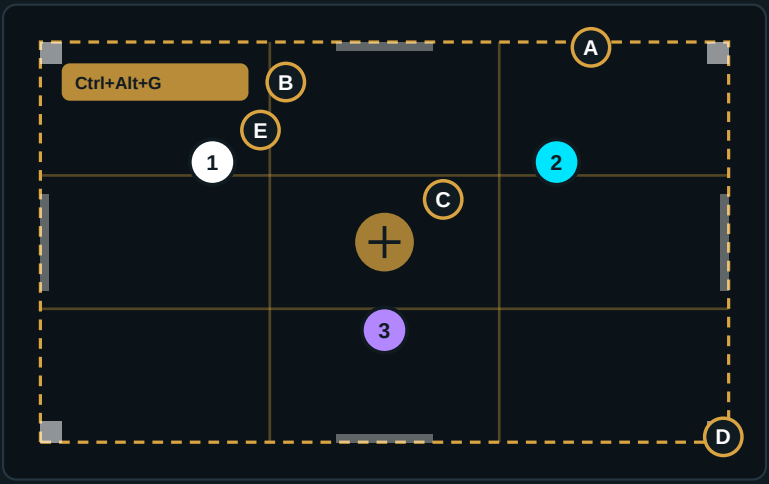
REQUIREMENTS

- Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit)
- No installation, no .NET to install
- Works offline
- Interface in French and English (FR / EN buttons)

Getting started

1. Run **OverlayGuides.exe**. The control panel and a first overlay open.
2. Place the overlay over your working area: the **round handle** in the center moves it, the **corners** and **edges** resize it.
3. Turn on the guides you want in the panel and pick their colors.
4. Press **Ctrl+Alt+G**: the overlay switches to click-through and you work normally in your software. The same shortcut brings back the interactive mode.

ANATOMY OF THE GUIDES WINDOW (INTERACTIVE MODE)



- **A** Dashed frame, in the overlay's color: it marks the limits of the area.
- **B** Badge reminding the Ctrl+Alt+G shortcut.
- **C** Round handle: drag it to move the window.
- **D** Corners and edges: drag them to resize.
- **E** Numbered markers, to drag anywhere you like.

> In click-through mode, all this “chrome” disappears: only the guides and markers remain.

QUICK REFERENCE

Move an overlay	**Drag the round handle in the center**
Resize an overlay	**Drag a corner or an edge**
Place a marker	**Drag the numbered circle**
Turn click-through on / off	**Ctrl+Alt+G**
Change the language	**FR / EN buttons in the panel**

The guides



Rule of thirds

Two vertical and two horizontal lines split the image into nine equal areas. Place important elements on the lines or at their intersections.



Golden ratio

Lines placed at about 38% and 62% of the width and height: a variant closer to the center than the rule of thirds.



Diagonals

The two diagonals of the image: useful for spotting vanishing lines and strong directions in the frame.



Center cross

The vertical and horizontal axes through the center: to center an element or check a symmetry.



Golden triangle

One diagonal, plus a perpendicular line from each of the two other corners, which cuts the image into triangles.



Golden triangle, mirrored

The “Flip” button shows the flipped figure, with the other diagonal (top-right to bottom-left).

Shared settings: line thickness, line opacity and background dimming apply to all the guides of an overlay. The **color** is chosen guide by guide (swatch at the right of each row).

Markers, tabs and window layer

Markers

Up to **3 numbered circles**, to drag anywhere in the overlay. They help you compare the position of an element along your camera axes. Each marker has its own color; “Reset positions” puts them back. Their position is relative to the window: they stay at the same logical spot if you resize it.

Multiple overlays (tabs)

The **“+ New overlay”** button creates an independent overlay in a new tab: its own guides, markers, style and layer. Each overlay has an **identification color** (tab dot, dashed frame of its window).

Ctrl+Alt+G applies to the overlay whose tab is selected. The **“Overlay active”** switch hides the overlay without closing it; the tab's **×** closes it. Closing the last tab quits the application.

Window layer

Overlay the content of another window, for example an already exported shot open in a player, to compare it with your working viewport.

1. Turn on **“Enable layer”**.
2. Click **“Choose a window…”** and select it in the list.
3. Adjust the layer **opacity**.

Single capture (default): one image of the window, updated with “Refresh capture”. It is lightweight and enough in most cases.
Real time: about 10 frames per second in a loop. Handy for comparing, but it is not a smooth video player.

Depending on the application, some windows may appear empty or black when captured. The chosen window is not remembered from one session to the next.

Tip

Create one overlay per use: for example a first one with the rule of thirds for framing, a second one with the layer of an exported shot for comparing. Each keeps its own settings, and the “Overlay active” switch lets you show or hide them with one click.

Frequently asked questions

Windows shows “Windows protected your PC” on first launch.

The file is not yet signed with a certificate recognized by Microsoft: Windows is cautious with new software that few people have downloaded. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Some antivirus programs may also be cautious.

How do I check that my file is authentic?

Compare its SHA-256 hash with the one on the download page. In PowerShell:

```
Get-FileHash .\OverlayGuides.exe -Algorithm SHA256
```

The overlay does not appear over my software.

It may not display over an exclusive full-screen application: switch it to windowed or borderless full-screen mode. Also check that “Overlay active” is turned on.

I can no longer click inside the overlay.

It is in click-through mode. Select its tab in the panel and press Ctrl+Alt+G again.

The Ctrl+Alt+G shortcut does not respond.

It applies to the overlay whose tab is selected. If nothing happens, another program may already be using this key combination.

Where are my settings saved? How do I reset them?

In the file below. Close the application and delete it to start from scratch:

```
%AppData%\OverlayGuides\config.json
```

How do I uninstall?

There is no installation: delete OverlayGuides.exe and, if you wish, the %AppData%\OverlayGuides folder.

Overlay Guides is **free** (freeware, closed source); the full license is on florindolab.com. I develop my tools in my spare time: if this one is useful to you, you can support me on ko-fi.com/florindolab. To report a bug or suggest an idea: florindolab.com · Instagram @florindolab.